

NOVEMBER NEWSLETTER

21 NOVEMBER 2022



FROM THE ASSISTANT DIRECTOR

Dear Families,

Christmas is approaching fast, and like always, Term 4 will be over in a flash!

Our wonderful educators are busy enjoying their end of year concert preparation with your children and we can't wait to share this with you.

The children have enjoyed visitors to the service this month, including 'Whizzy the Waterdrop' where we were read an interactive story book and joined in a song about looking after water, as well as high fives and cuddles from whizzy. Also, we had Lee a dental nurse, visit from Taree Dental Hospital to read a story and talk about tooth hygiene with the preschool children. We do like involving families and the community into our programs, so please know my door is open to your ideas and knowledge.

Enrolments are almost full for 2023, with 3 days already at staffing capacity, so if your circumstances change regarding your child's enrolment, it would be best to notify me asap to confirm availability.

Kind regards,

Kareen

2023 PRESCHOOL ENROLMENTS

Preschool enrolments are capped at 2 days a week in 2023. Extra days are available as Long Day Care bookings. Your child will be in the same room each week, regardless of if they attend preschool days or long day care days.

If you have booked your child in for 3 or more days in 2023, please ensure you have completed your Child Care Subsidy Assessment with Centrelink. If you have any questions on the Child Care Subsidy, please speak to Robyn.

CASUAL BOOKINGS

Casual days in 2023 will need to be booked in as Long Day Care days. We advise families to complete a Child Care Subsidy Assessment with Centrelink if you think you may need casual days next year.

END OF YEAR CONCERT

1st December—This year we will be gathering on the grounds of Gloucester Public School for a picnic dinner. Families need to bring a picnic rug and food for their family. After the meal the children will gather to sing a few of their favourite songs and for those who will be going to school in 2023, they will be acknowledged and receive their graduation certificate. Save the date: Thursday 1st December at 6pm to 7:30pm.

VACATION CARE

Vacation Care booking form has been emailed to families recently. Vacation care is available from Tuesday 10th January to Friday 27th January. Please return the completed form by Monday 5th December.

STAFFING

Farewell Jac

I am sure families have noticed that Jac has been growing a bundle of joy over the last 6 months. The children have enjoyed sharing this experience with Jac, asking lots of questions. Jacklyn is finishing up with the service on 2nd December. We wish Jac all the best with the birth of her first child. Leanne will be working full time for the remaining 2 weeks, from 5th December, to cover Jac. Thank you Leanne.

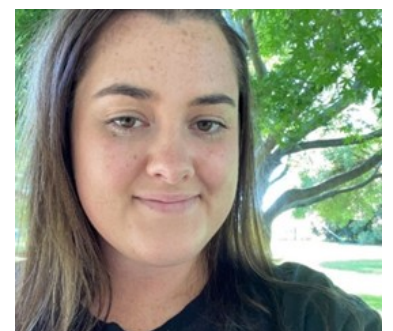
EQUIPMENT PURCHASES

- ◆ Soccer and Football balls (donated by Bunnings)
- ◆ Wooden baby toys
- ◆ Dolls prams
- ◆ Play tents with tunnel
- ◆ Trikes and trailers



DATES TO REMEMBER

- **End of Year Concert/ Graduation—Thurs 1 Dec @ 6pm Gloucester Primary School Infants Playground**
- **Term 4 Ends—Monday 19 Dec (for preschool enrolments) & Thurs 22 Dec (for Long Day Care)**
- **Centre re-opens Tuesday 10th January 2023 for LDC & Vacation Care.**
- **Preschool Term 1 commences Monday 30 January 2023**



Farewell Jac

END OF YEAR CLOSURE DATES

Last day for Preschool enrolments will be Mon 19th December.

Last Day for Long Day Care will be Thursday 22nd December.

LDC and Vacation Care will be re-open on Tuesday 10th January 2023.

Preschool enrolments, Term 1 starts on Monday 30th January 2023

Vacation Care is available for Preschool enrolments **Tuesday 10th January to Friday 27th January**



THANK YOU FATHERS BREAKFAST

Thank you to the committee for planning our father's picnic in park this month. A special thank you to the small number of families who attended our picnic, it was a wonderful morning spent playing games, eating yummy food and enjoying company and conversation.



WEBSITE

In 2022 we have focused on upgrading our website, with assistance from Paul Goldsmith. We have developed a "members section" where families can log in and access resources, policies, and newsletters. The member's section was created to keep our information more secure than being available on the website for the public to see and read. Families returning in 2023 will receive a link for signing into the members area. You will be required to create your own password when logging in for the first time. If you have questions about the website, please speak to Robyn.

POSITIONS VACANT

Gloucester Pre-School and Early Years Learning Centre is looking to employ a highly motivated male or female to be part of our vibrant, dynamic and friendly team. We are looking to employ a Cert III or Cert III trainee. Applicants will need to access our website www.gloucesterpreschool.com.au and follow the directions under Positions Vacant. Enquiries to assistant.director@gloucesterpreschool.com.au

BLUE-TONGUE LIZARDS

We are lucky to have several blue-tongue lizards living within the services yards. There is one currently residing in the entry courtyard and can often be seen in the morning and afternoon's sunning himself beside the path. He has managed to scare a few families (and staff) when walking along the path so please be mindful he may be lurking in the garden, but I promise he won't harm you and I am sure he doesn't mean to scare you.

GET READY FOR 'MOSQUITO SEASON'

As a result of the warm and wet weather conditions in many parts of NSW, the prevalence of mosquitoes in some areas has recently increased.

If you would like us to apply repellent to your child before going outside after lunch, please supply a repellent cream in your child's bag and email admin@gloucesterpreschool.com.au to notify us.



COVID-19

NSW Health is seeing several indicators that a new Covid-19 wave has begun. Cases are expected to increase over the coming weeks.

We strongly encourage families to follow the NSW Health advice to help keep children, educators and the community safe. Therefore, please, we ask all families to keep unwell children at home. We understand this is a struggle on families who are working or studying, however for the wellbeing of all we will be sending children home who show symptoms of covid-19.

To support services, the department will provide additional supplies of Rapid Antigen Tests, that will be placed in your child's file to go home.

HYGIENE PRACTICES

Staff have been reviewing our hygiene practices at the centre including monitoring the use of drink bottles and ensuring that children use their own drink bottles and do not share.

Drink bottles need to be emptied and washed with hot soapy water regularly, and need to be clearly labelled with your child's name.

"Did you know it is recommended that water bottles are washed as often as you wash your drinking cups and glasses? If you don't, they can become smelly and mouldy so, keeping your family's water bottles clean and stored correctly is important.

Filling your water bottles with fresh water is best. And remember, over time the plastic will deteriorate. Replacing your water bottles regularly (at least once a year) is recommended.

WAYS TO KEEP DRINK BOTTLES CLEAN

- Tip unused water out at the end of the day.
- Wash water bottles with warm soapy water every day. Some water bottles are dishwasher safe, if so pop them in to get a thorough clean.
- If your water bottles need a more intense clean, try bi-carb (baking soda) or vinegar. Avoid using bleach as it is not safe to consume and leaves an odour.
- If a bottle has visible black mould spots. Wash and scrub to remove mould, then [wash again]."

- extract from https://doh.health.tas.gov.au/healthykids/blog/how_to_clean_water_bottles

CHILDREN'S HEALTH & INFECTIONS

Whenever children are together, there is a chance of spreading infections. This is especially true among infants and toddlers who are likely to use their hands to wipe their noses or rub their eyes and then handle toys or touch other children. These children then touch their noses and rub their eyes, so the virus goes from the nose or eyes of one child by way of hands or toys to the next child which then rubs his own eyes or nose. And children get sick a lot in the first several years of life as their bodies are building immunity to infections.

Even with the best hygiene measures in place in childcare services, it is likely that some infections will be spread in the childcare centers. For many of these infections, a child is contagious a day or more before they have symptoms.

These are some of the measures we use to promote good hygiene in our service:

- ◆ There are separate sinks for preparing food and washing hands.
- ◆ Toilets and sinks cleaned several times throughout the day.
- ◆ Washable hand towels are used so each child will use only his own towel and are changed daily.
- ◆ Toys that are put in children's mouth especially those in the babies and toddlers' rooms are washed before others can play with them?
- ◆ All doors and cabinet handles, all surfaces in the toileting and nappy change areas are cleaned and disinfected daily. (During a COVID outbreak and any other infectious outbreak it is done several times a day).
- ◆ All change tables are cleaned and disinfected after each use.
- ◆ Children and their educators wash their hands throughout the day including these key times: before eating, after toileting, after nose blowing/wiping, before and after first aid and after cleaning jobs.

The average preschool child has at least six colds a year. Sometimes, especially in winter, it might seem that your child is sick for weeks at a time, barely getting over one cold before getting another one.

Young children get sick a lot in the first few years of life as their bodies are building immunity to infections. As your child grows older, they'll gradually build up immunity and get fewer sicknesses.

YAPII ROOM NEWS

We have had an exciting week last week with the arrival of our baby chickens which hatched on the 4th of November so they are over a week old now. The children have been helping to care for them, change their bedding and feed them, we are learning to be gentle with them and building on our understanding of empathy and respect for other living things.



We have also been watching closely as our sunflowers are growing taller each day and our sweet peas have flowered too. We are eagerly waiting for our passionfruit to be ready so we can all have a taste. The children have also planted some tomato and pumpkin seeds in the other gardens which will hopefully contribute to the kitchen when they grow. What are you growing in your gardens? We would love to see your photos.

BANGGU ROOM NEWS

This month the children in the Banggu room have been exploring taking care of our environment through helping to design and grow new plants in our garden beds in the EYLC. With the Yapii room, the children have also been exploring their social connections with one another using sensory play, especially the water play. As the weather continues to warm up, I'm sure we will see more and more of this, so please remember to apply sunscreen to your child at drop-off and mark it off on the checklist.



DAPIN ROOM NEWS

This has been an exciting month as our projects have been shared between exploring Dulcie and Imogen's fossils, hatching our 8 eggs and caring for our new chickens, exploring our planet and how to care for it. Playing with our chickens has been lots of fun! Learning to be gentle, checking for food and water and cleaning their enclosure is all part of learning what it is to be responsible for a pet. Our chickens each have a name now and the poster is displayed above the enclosure in our classroom. These chickens will be seeking new homes at the end of term, the children in the Dapin room are asked to let Jenny, Jac or Jasmine know if you would be interested in going into our chicken draw.



Transition to School Program

Every day this term the children who will graduate into kindergarten next year have been engaged in specialised activities that are designed to help prepare them for the significant changes in learning that they are embarking on. It is wonderful to see how excited they all are about going into kindergarten and putting their best effort into all the experiences. Some of these include working with numbers, colours and shapes. The feedback that we have received from the children's 2023 Teachers is that your children are showing confidence and excitement during their transition visits.



GAWUL ROOM NEWS

In the Gawul room, the children have been enjoying the warm Spring weather by taking walks to the park and shops. The children have been showing their appreciation of the nature around them as they explored the blooming flowers in the park whilst having a picnic under the tree. They have applied their knowledge of caring for the environment as they shopped for recycled materials in the Op shops and learned about the different types of recycling bins in town. They have also been appreciating the amazing process of the bees pollinating the flowers in the citrus and passionfruit trees in the preschool garden. They are enjoying caring for their growing vegetables, they have planted last term, and noticing all the bugs and animals living around them, which is the focus of our project book. They have been learning about bees, ants, spiders, and worms and their importance to our ecosystem.



KITCHEN NEWS

Here are some examples of the food served to your children and some photos of the children enjoying their meal.



Dealing with a Fussy Eater: Tips & Tricks

1. Food on a stick is often a winner—vegetable and fruit skewers will often get children excited.
2. If your child is struggling with a texture, try other foods with similar nutrients. For example, yoghurt instead of milk; mince instead of chewy meat; raw or grated vegetables instead of cooked vegetables.
3. Give your child options, but limit these to two to three at a time. (eg would you like carrots or broccoli?)
4. Set a time limit on meals of about 20 minutes. Use a visual timer to help remind children of how long there is left before mealtime is over. Remind children when there is 5 minutes left, they might not have an adult concept of time, but they will recognize that this warning means there isn't much time left.
5. Involve your child in the cooking process. Ask them to help you choose a recipe, wash the vegetables or set the table before a meal.
6. Try not to let your child fill up on drinks or snacks before a meal. As a rule of thumb, nothing but water to eat or drink for one hour prior to mealtimes is appropriate.
7. If they are hassling you that they are hungry before dinner is ready, offer raw vegetable sticks as it doesn't matter at what time of the day they eat their veggies!
8. If your child finds it hard to settle down at the table, ensure they start winding down at least 15 minutes before a meal. Have them stop whatever they are doing and sit and read a book, wash their hands or some other quiet activity to calm them before mealtimes.

(Excerpt from Dealing with a Fussy Eater: The Ultimate List of Tips & Tricks—Fairfield Paediatrics)

Cupboard of Shared Happiness

The cupboard is operating, please check the table on the verandah and the fridge and freezer.

Please donate if you can, and please feel free to help yourself to donated items.

WHAT HAPPENS TO YOUR KIDS WHEN THEY'RE BAREFOOT?

WHAT PARENTS THINK HAPPENS:

UMMM, NOT MUCH. THEY'RE JUST BAREFOOT. THEIR FEET MIGHT GET DIRTY, OR THEY MIGHT STUB THEIR TOE.



WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS:

- FEET CAN FEEL!
- FUELS PROPRIOCEPTION AND BALANCE.
- MUSCLES AND LIGAMENTS MOVE AND GROW STRONG AND FLEXIBLE.
- MAINTAINS NATURAL WALKING AND RUNNING GAIT.
- BAREFOOT KIDS HAVE WIDER, STRONGER FEET AND FEWER FALLEN ARCHES.
- BAREFOOT KIDS HAVE BETTER BALANCE AND MOTOR SKILLS.

SCHOOL READINESS

Below are some helpful links to prepare your child for Kindergarten

Link for Starting School from NSW Government

<https://education.nsw.gov.au/public-schools/going-to-a-public-school/primary-schools/starting-school>

Link to Getting Ready to School from NSW Education Department

<https://education.nsw.gov.au/content/dam/main-education/public-schools/going-to-a-public-school/media/documents/getting-ready-for-school.pdf>

FOUNDATION WRITING

Attached is the foundation writing script that your child will use throughout their schooling. It is important that they learn the current letter formation from an early age so 'bad' habits do not form, as these are hard to break. When assisting your child, talk about the directions that letters in their name are written. Try to discourage them from writing in capital letters except where required. Always make drawing and writing a positive experience.

Tips to strengthen your child's pencil grip.

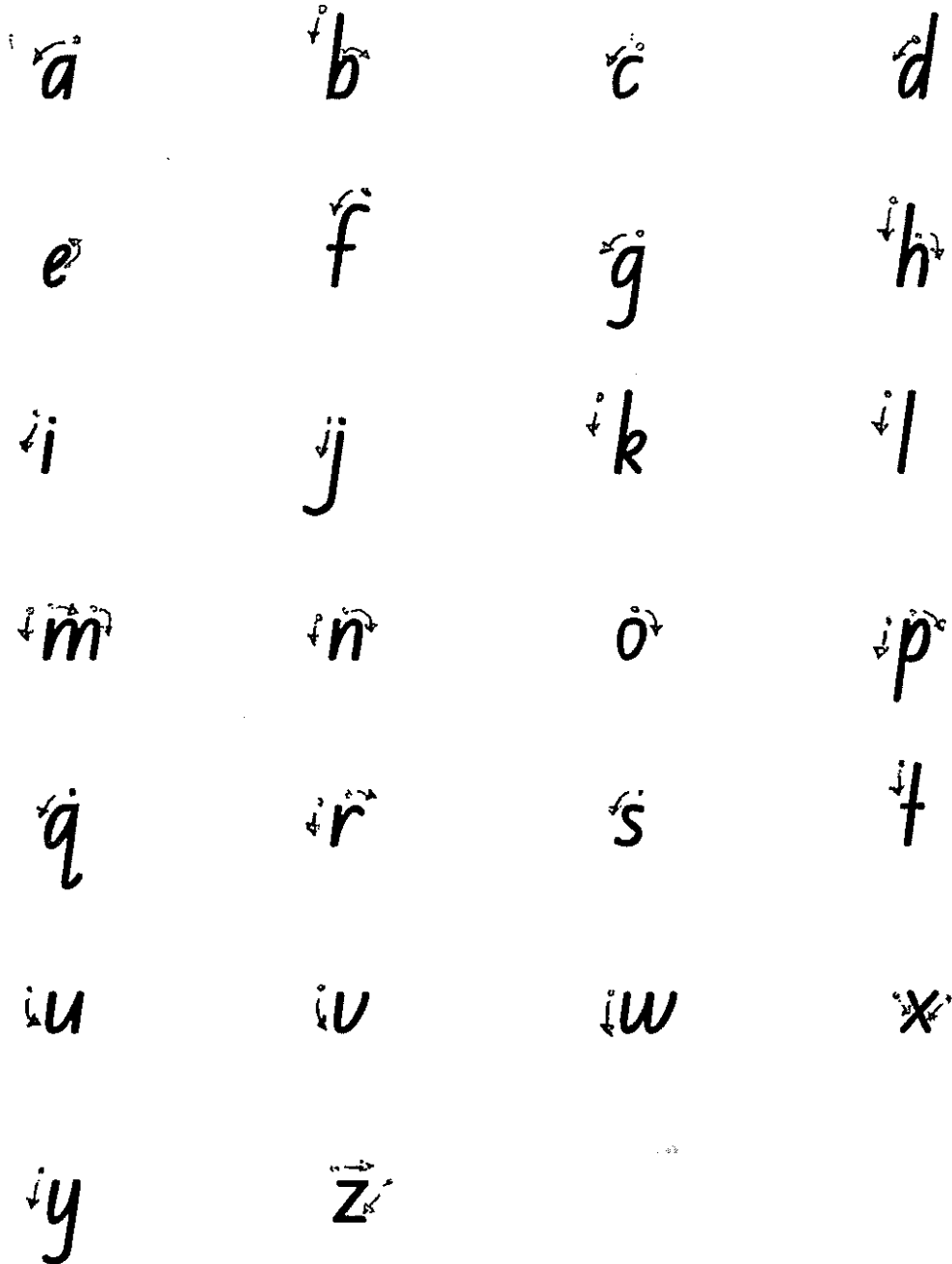
- ◆ Using pegs encouraging the use of the thumb and pointer finger.
- ◆ Picking up small objects such as marbles, glitter, small pebbles.
- ◆ Have your child touch their thumb to each other finger on that hand, one at a time.
- ◆ Tearing paper.
- ◆ Snipping with scissors.
- ◆ Picking up small objects with tweezers

Good posture is so vital in the proper functioning of the body and the development of handwriting.

The most important thing to know, is that posture is a habit and a habit can be learned over time. Correct seated posture consists of having the pelvis symmetrical and upright with bottom, well back into the seat; hips, knees and ankles at 90 degrees and forearm able to rest on table.

Letter Formation

This is a sample of the way the children will be taught to form and write each letter. You may like to refer to it when your child is writing their name.



- Indicates pencil starts here.